THE COMMIT BOOK

THE COMMIT BOOK · PLAYBOOK

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For families who want a strong school and a roster spot. Checked 2026-11-05.
Edition 2026-27 · Rules checked 2026-11-05 · Education, not legal advice. No outcome promised.
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For families who want a strong school and a roster spot. Checked 2026-11-05.

> Education, not legal advice. Nothing here promises admission, aid, an offer, a roster spot or playing time. Confirm every rule with each school's compliance and financial aid offices. `TO VERIFY` = we could not confirm against a primary source on 2026-11-05.

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1. HOW D3 AID WORKS

Division III schools don't award athletically related aid. Aid is academic (merit) or need-based, and it must be awarded to athletes on the same basis as other students (D3 Bylaw 15, per site/data.js and NCAA D3 guidance). `TO VERIFY`: exact D3 Bylaw 15 section numbers against the 2026-27 D3 Manual (LSDBi 90011); we have checked only the D1 Manual text directly.

What this means for you: the coach can't hand you money. The coach can often help in admissions. Your grades and your aid application do the money work.

2. THE D3 CALENDAR

DATE	TYPE	WHAT	RULE
Any time	OPEN	D3 coaches may generally contact you earlier than D1. `TO VERIFY` current D3 Bylaw 13 contact rules	D3 Bylaw 13 — `TO VERIFY`
Sophomore year	YOUR PLAN	Build relationships; parent reports say D3 coaches engage before June 15	Forum report, not a rule
2028-01-01	OPENING	D3 official (paid) visits, Class of 2029	D3 Bylaw 13.6.1.1.1
Fall 2028	YOUR PLAN	Early Decision / Early Action deadlines (school-set)	Each school
Fall 2028	`HARD` (school-set)	FAFSA and CSS Profile, if required	Each school's aid office

No National Letter of Intent or athletics aid agreement exists in D3. `TO VERIFY`: whether a school offers a non-binding D3 celebratory signing form.

3. NET PRICE, HONESTLY

Use each school's federally required Net Price Calculator (on its financial-aid page). Enter the same family numbers every time. Then compare what's left to pay, not the sticker price or a "merit award".

4. ADMISSIONS SUPPORT VS COACH INTEREST

Ask directly: will you submit my name to admissions as a supported recruit? Does support change my odds, or only timing? Should I apply Early Decision? ED is binding at most schools: you commit before you see competing aid.

5. COACH QUESTIONS

- How many players at my position are you adding for 2029?
- How many first-years made the travel roster last year?
- Can I get a pre-read of my financial aid before ED?
- What does a typical athlete's week look like in season?

6. TRACKERS

Net cost comparison

SCHOOL	STICKER COA	MERIT AID	NEED-BASED GRANT	LOANS OFFERED	NET TO PAY/YR	4-YR TOTAL

Visit score (1-5)

SCHOOL	ACADEMICS/MAJOR	COACH	TEAM CULTURE	PLAYING CHANCE	NET COST	TOTAL

7. SOURCES

- NCAA Division III Manual (LSDBi 90011): https://web3.ncaa.org/lsdbi/reports/getReport/90011 — Bylaw 13.6.1.1.1 as cited in site/data.js (checked 2026-11-05); Bylaw 15 and 13 contact rules `TO VERIFY`.
- r/CollegeSoccer thread 2026-02-13 (paraphrased parent reports, not a rule).
- Federal Net Price Calculator requirement: `TO VERIFY` current Dept. of Education page.